

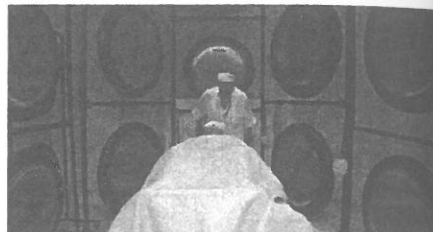
ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a magazine in Hong Kong:

To reduce stress, sink into a sound bath (no water required)

Gong baths are a type of music therapy that have been used for healing for thousands of years. Canadian-born Martha Collard wants to help as many people as possible to lower stress in fast-paced Hong Kong. To do this, she set up Red Doors Studio, where she hosts gong baths. We gave it a try.



What is a gong bath?

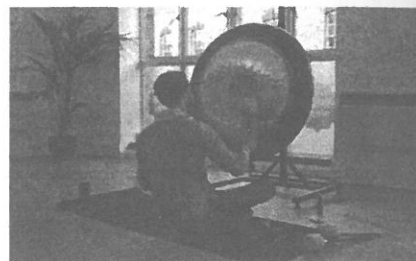
Don't be confused by the word bath – there is no water. It's the sound waves that you are bathed in. Healing with harmonious sound, such as singing or drumming has been used to clear minds and bodies for thousands of years and gongs (basically flat metal drums) are ideal for this.

How does it work?

Taking a gong bath is easy. You don't have to do anything except lie down and close your eyes. Get under the comfortable blanket, have a lavender-scented eye pillow placed over your eyes and ... gong.

How does it feel?

The emotional effect was instant: I had tears in my eyes and the hairs on my arms stood up. Collard says everyone's reaction is different. "Some people laugh, some cry." Immediately after the session I felt "fuzzy", as if in a dreamlike state but a few hours later I had intense focus and energy: I was "buzzing" so much that I found it difficult to sleep, something that never normally happens.



Decision

I will definitely make it a regular thing.

Your school is going to use a room for music therapy. Your group has been asked to suggest a suitable music therapy activity to be introduced to the room. You may want to talk about:

- whether a gong bath would be suitable
- other music therapy activities that might be suitable
- how to promote music therapy at your school
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to try a gong bath?
2. Do you think gong baths will become popular?
3. What do you usually do to relax?
4. Should schools use music and sounds to help students reduce stress?
5. Are students more stressed than adults?
6. What do you feel is the biggest cause of stress in Hong Kong?
7. Can stress be productive?
8. Do you think we should encourage more traditional ways of reducing stress?